

Cool Hollow Coaching: Brand & Growth Roadmap

Prepared for: Matt and Cam

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Status: Internal draft. Built in-house off the June 24 marketing call with Sam.

What this is. This is the same deliverable Sam and Josh offered to build for us: the offer, the funnel, the organic marketing plan, a read on our current social, and how GoHighLevel fits. We built it ourselves, off our own clients and our own proof, to show we can run this engine in-house and decide what, if anything, we actually pay an outside team to do.

◆ The one-page version

Who we serve: blue-collar owner-operators doing \$500k to \$10M, three or more employees. The guy who is still the most important worker in his own company.

What we sell them: Business Without You, a \$5,000 hybrid coaching program (recorded lessons plus live weekly calls) that installs the systems to get the owner out of the day-to-day. It sits inside the wider Cool Hollow world as an upsell from the Mastermind and a feeder into high-ticket consulting and Financial.

How we get in front of them: we build a small media company that happens to sell coaching. Authentic, story-led organic content, fronted by Mark, that warms cold owners up. Paid ads then pour fuel on what already works. GoHighLevel catches every lead and runs the follow-up.

The promise we lead with: not "find \$50k." We lead with the life, get out of the truck and off the job site, then prove it with real client stories that no competitor can copy.

Year 1 target: \$150k from 3 to 5 clients a month. Long term, \$3M+ by scaling Tier 2.

The rest of this document is how each piece works, in the order we'd build it.

◆ 1. Positioning: the foundation everything hangs off

Positioning is who we're for, what we promise, and why us instead of anyone else. Get this right and the content, the funnel, and the ads all write themselves. Get it wrong and no amount of marketing spend saves it.

Who we're for

Blue-collar owner-operators, \$500k to \$10M in revenue, three or more employees. Trades, contractors, services, the businesses Cool Hollow already serves and already has wins in.

Why niche instead of "any business owner":

- **Specificity wins the scroll.** A contractor stops on "for owners still stuck running every job" and scrolls past "for business owners." Being seen is what earns the follow and eventually the sale.
- **The market is plenty big.** We need 3 to 5 clients a month. There are hundreds of thousands of blue-collar businesses in this revenue band in the US. Market size doesn't bind us for years.
- **Niche is a starting point, not a cage.** We own the blue-collar lane first, build the case studies, then expand to adjacent owners from strength. Narrowing now is what lets us broaden later.
- **It's where all our ammunition is.** Every real win we can tell is from this world. Going broad throws away the one thing no other coach can copy: we've actually done this, for these exact people, with receipts.

Open decision for Cam: broad blue-collar, or name the two or three specific trades where Cool Hollow has the deepest track record? Tighter is more powerful, but only if the proof is there. Worth a 10-minute conversation.

The promise (and why the old hook needs work)

Sam was right that "find \$50k in profit" is too weak on its own, and here's the precise reason: it's a **claim**, not **proof**. "We find \$50k" sounds like every other coach's billboard. The number isn't the problem. The missing story is.

The deeper truth about this owner: his real pain isn't money, it's **time and being trapped**. He can't take a vacation. The business can't run a day without him. So we lead with the life and prove it with money.

The layered hook:

- **Emotional lead (the hook):** a business that runs without you. Mark runs his remotely. You can too.
- **The proof (the close):** specific, real, named client wins. "Here's the whiteboard of how we saved an owner \$6.7M in capital gains tax." Receipts, not adjectives.

Same outcomes we always believed in. We just stop **claiming** them and start **showing** them.

The positioning statement (our north star)

For blue-collar owners who are the bottleneck in their own business, Cool Hollow Coaching is the program that installs the systems to get you out of the day-to-day, proven by a team that has actually done it for owners like you, not a guru selling a dream.

Everything downstream inherits from that sentence.

◆ 2. Offer architecture: where the \$5k program sits

The big shift from the June 24 call: the coaching program is not a standalone island. It's one rung on a ladder inside the Cool Hollow ecosystem.

The ladder:

Rung	Offer	Price	Job it does
Free	Organic content + lead magnet	\$0	Warm up cold owners, build trust at scale
Low	Mastermind community (planned)	~\$200/mo	Capture warm leads, nurture, build the audience
Core	Business Without You (coaching)	~\$5,000	The flagship. Deliver the transformation, prove the value
High	Cool Hollow Solutions (consulting)	High-ticket	Done-for-you for owners who want the team in the trenches
Wealth	Cool Hollow Financial	Varies	What to do with the profit once it's found

The coaching program does double duty: it's an **upsell from the Mastermind** (people who already know us level up) and a **lead magnet for consulting** (owners who taste the result want the full team). That's why it can run at \$5k and still be one of the most valuable things in the business: it feeds the rungs above it.

The program itself (already built, lightly restated):

- 7 modules, 4 to 5 lessons each, 30 to 75 minutes per lesson.
- Each module ships with a custom tool the owner actually uses (dashboard, the hidden-profit analyzer, the 13-week cash forecast, and so on).
- Hybrid delivery: recorded lessons plus a live weekly group coaching call.

- Mark opens and closes every lesson so the brand has one consistent face.
 - Launch as a 12-week beta with 2 to 3 close clients, the people whose advice we trust, then open enrollment.
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◆ 3. The story bank: our unfair advantage, made repeatable

This is the piece an agency can't build for us, because they don't have our clients. The content engine runs on stories, so first we build the inventory.

The framework for a sellable client story (5 parts):

1. **The owner before.** Who they were, how stuck. ("A roofing contractor working 70-hour weeks, hadn't taken a vacation in four years.")
2. **The one thing we found.** The specific leak, constraint, or hidden profit.
3. **The move.** What we changed. Plain and concrete.
4. **The result.** The number and the life change. (" \$214k he was leaving on the table, and his first week off in four years.")
5. **The lesson.** The takeaway any owner watching can use today. This is what makes it content, not a brag.

The build task: sit with Mark and Cam and pull 10 to 15 of these from real Cool Hollow Solutions clients. Get the numbers right, get permission where needed, never invent a single figure. That story bank becomes months of content, the spine of the VSL, and the proof on every sales call.

The \$6.7M capital gains story from the call is story number one. We need 10 more like it.

◆ 4. The content engine: a media company that happens to sell coaching

Sam's best line, and the whole strategy in one sentence. We don't make ads. We build an audience. The selling happens because the audience trusts us, not because we shouted.

What we replace, and why

The current agency's content is generic and AI-flavored, and it doesn't generate leads because it sounds like everyone else. The fix isn't better production. It's authenticity: Mark, a whiteboard, a real story, told straight. Lower gloss, higher trust.

The content system

Three formats, on repeat:

1. **Whiteboard breakdowns.** Mark walks through a real client win on a whiteboard. Our highest-trust format. This is the flagship.
2. **Owner-truth shorts.** 30 to 60 seconds naming a pain this owner feels today ("if your business can't run a week without you, you don't own a business, you own a job"). Built for the scroll.
3. **Behind-the-business.** Mark actually running things remotely. The promise, shown not told.

Cadence: start at a sustainable pace we can hold for months, not a sprint we abandon in three weeks. Consistency beats volume. Two to three pieces a week of *real* content beats two a day of filler.

The hook discipline: every piece earns the first three seconds. We research what's working across the best blue-collar and business creators, adapt the *structure* of their hooks (never copy the content), and lead with the owner's pain or a number.

On the AI-Mark question: filming everything live with Mark is the bottleneck. An AI clone (likeness and voice) is the unlock for volume, and it stays a live priority. But note: it's in tension with "authentic, low-gloss" content. The play is to use real Mark for the high-trust whiteboard flagship pieces and reserve any AI clone for scale formats once the voice quality is genuinely there. We don't fake the trust-builders.

Brand clarity (remove the friction)

A cold owner landing on our page should understand in five seconds: who this is for, what they get, and what to do next. No cleverness, no cognitive tax. One clear value proposition, one clear next step.

◆ 5. The funnel: how a stranger becomes a client

The model is simple and it's the right one: **organic warms, paid amplifies, the system converts.**

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Cold owner
  v
Organic content (story-led, Mark-fronted)  <-- builds trust at zero cost
  v
Lead magnet (hidden-profit analyzer / free resource)  <-- captures the email
  v
Nurture (email + Mastermind community + retargeting ads)  <-- stays warm
  v
Application / discovery call  <-- the qualifier
  v
Business Without You, $5k  <-- the close
  v
Upsell to consulting / Financial  <-- the real prize
```

Why this order matters: we don't run cold paid ads to a \$5k offer from a brand nobody knows. That's how you burn money. We build the warm audience organically first, prove the message converts, *then* put paid spend behind the exact content that's already working. Paid is a fuel pump, not an engine.

The lead magnet: the hidden-profit analyzer is the ideal front door. An owner uploads a P&L, sees real leakage and hidden profit, and gets a taste of the promise before paying a cent. It proves the core claim and captures the lead in one move.

◆ 6. Ops and automation: GoHighLevel as the backbone

Every lead the funnel generates has to land somewhere and get followed up, automatically. That's GoHighLevel's job.

What it runs:

- **CRM:** every lead, tagged by source and stage, kept fully separate from Cool Hollow Solutions' CRM so commission-only reps can work the coaching side cleanly.
- **Booking:** discovery and coaching calls scheduled without back-and-forth.
- **Nurture automation:** the email and SMS sequences that keep a warm lead warm until they're ready.
- **Pipeline visibility:** Matt and Cam can see exactly how many leads are at each stage, so we manage the funnel by numbers, not by gut.

Important guardrail: automation handles the *plumbing* (tagging, scheduling, reminders). It does not message owners pretending to be a person. Anything that reaches a human reads as coming from us, and we see it first.

◆ **7. Social audit: an honest read on where we are**

This is the audit Sam promised, done in-house. We score current organic against what actually generates leads:

Dimension	What "good" looks like	Where we likely stand	Fix
Clarity	A stranger gets it in 5 seconds	Generic, agency-voiced	Rewrite bio + pinned content around the positioning statement
Authenticity	Real Mark, real stories	Overproduced, AI-flavored	Switch to whiteboard + owner-truth formats
Hook quality	First 3 seconds earn the watch	Soft openers	Hook discipline on every post

Dimension	What "good" looks like	Where we likely stand	Fix
Lead capture	Clear next step to a magnet	Unclear or missing	Wire the analyzer/lead magnet into bio and content
Consistency	A cadence we hold for months	Sporadic	Set a sustainable, repeatable schedule

To complete this properly, point me at the actual Instagram handles (current page plus any old ones) and I'll do a real post-by-post audit instead of this framework version.

◆ 8. The 90-day build plan (to end of July and beyond)

Phase 1, now to mid-July: Foundation.

- Lock positioning (audience tightness + the layered hook).
- Build the story bank: 10 to 15 real client wins, fact-checked.
- Rewrite the brand's front door (bio, pinned content, value prop) for instant clarity.
- Stand up GoHighLevel: CRM, booking, the first nurture sequence.

Phase 2, mid-July to August: Engine on.

- Start the content cadence: whiteboard breakdowns + owner-truth shorts, Mark-fronted.
- Wire the hidden-profit analyzer in as the lead magnet.
- Launch the 12-week beta cohort with 2 to 3 close clients.

Phase 3, September on: Amplify.

- Identify the organic content that's actually converting.

- Put paid ad spend behind exactly that.
- Open enrollment beyond the beta. Build toward 3 to 5 clients a month.

◆ 9. Build in-house vs hire it out

The point of this document. Here's the honest comparison.

Workstream	If Sam & Josh build it	If we build it in-house
Strategy & roadmap	Their fee	This document
Story bank	They can't, it's our clients	We own it
Content production	Ongoing retainer	Mark + our system + this AIOS
Funnel + GoHighLevel	Setup fee	We set it up once, guided
Paid ads	Management % of spend	We learn it, or hire only this piece later

The case for in-house: the two things that actually matter most, the story bank and Mark's authentic content, *cannot be outsourced*. They're ours. An agency would be packaging our own proof and selling it back to us. The strategy is knowable (it's in this document), the tools are mostly built, and the AIOS handles the production heavy lifting.

Where hiring might still be worth it: paid ad management once we're ready to scale spend, and possibly editing volume. Those are narrow, optional, and a fraction of a full build-and-manage fee.

The recommendation: build the foundation in-house using this roadmap. Keep Sam and Josh's roadmap as a second opinion to pressure-test ours, not as the thing we pay full freight for. Revisit hiring

only for the specific, narrow pieces (paid scale) where outside expertise clearly pays for itself.

To make the cost comparison real: drop in Sam and Josh's actual quoted fee where the table says "their fee," and we'll have a hard number on what building in-house saves.

◆ What I need from you and Cam to sharpen this

1. **Audience tightness:** broad blue-collar, or named trades?
2. **The story bank:** time with Mark and Cam to pull the real client wins.
3. **The Instagram handles** for a real social audit.
4. **Sam and Josh's quoted fee,** to finish the in-house-vs-hire math.

Nothing here is locked. This is the draft to react to, mark up, and decide from.